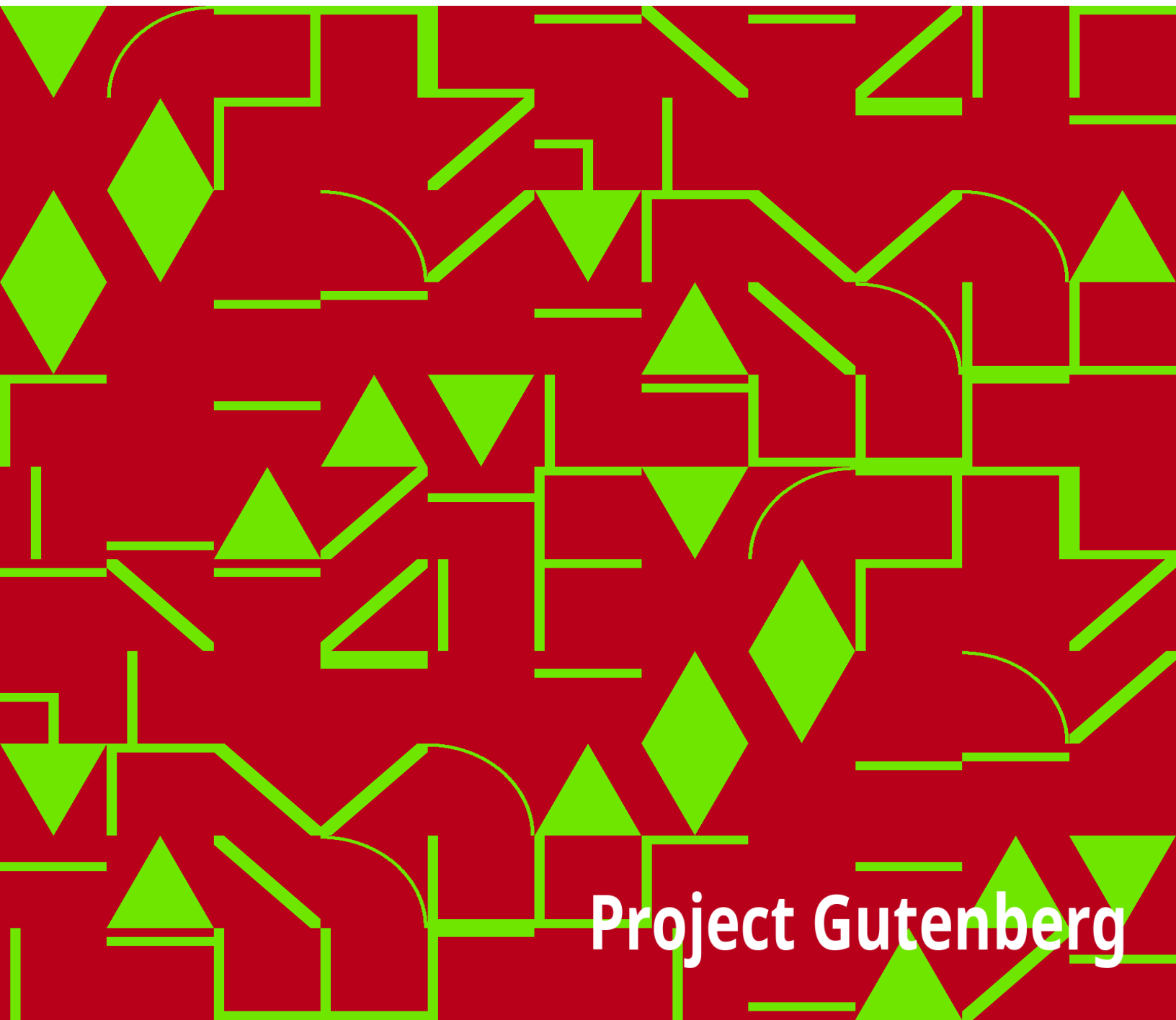


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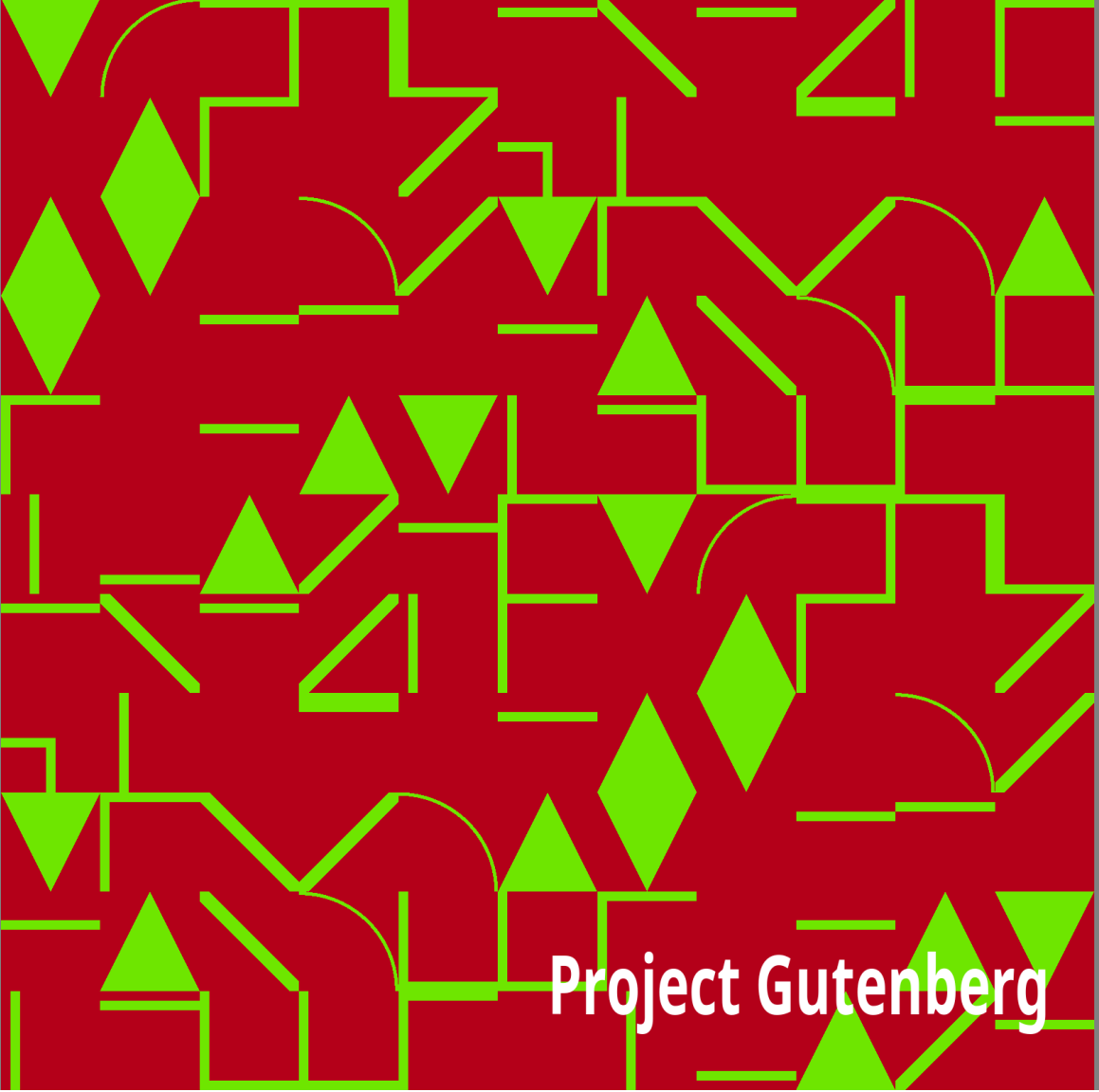
Anselmo de Moraes

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**Suplemento ao n.º 7 das Insomnias de
Camillo Castello Branco**

Anselmo de Moraes



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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK SUPLEMENTO
AO N.º 7 DAS INSOMNIAS DE CAMILLO CASTELLO BRANCO ***

SUPLEMENTO AO N.º 7

DAS

INSOMNIAS

DE

CAMILLO CASTELLO BRANCO

O tratamento da gangrena é o ferro em braza; os grandes perversos eram também marcados com o ferro em braza na testa ou nas costas para condenação permanente. Temos hoje de applicar este tratamento na pessoa de *Camillo Castello Branco*, pela sua dupla qualidade de podridão physica e degradação moral. Ha muitos annos que este galeriano se tornou o symbolo da torpeza de costumes, da indignidade em todos os actos da sua vida, uma especie de cadaver ambulante dentro do qual vomita corrupção um vampiro que exhala o asco da sacristia, a atrocidade do covil, a vilania do alcouce, e a linguagem desenfreada do açougue. A cara d'este monstro, ultraje da especie humana, é a sua biographia; n'ella estão escriptos os vergões das chicotadas publicas que tem levado, e ainda se vêem as manchas dos escarros de desprezo que tem provocado. O amolecimento da espinha dorsal, a que a natureza o condemnou, é a historia da crápula em que se tem revolvido; emfim o idiotismo de que se está sentindo possuir arrasta-o para o abysmo da bestialidade d'onde nunca teria sahido, se o caso de uma infamia o não trouxesse de guardador de cabras em Villa Real para uma terra grande como o Porto, que o tem tollerado como uma especie de cloaca maxima, como o sumidouro de todas as paixões abjectas que se manifestam ás vezes em qualquer sociedade.

A côr livida d'este miseravel que em França nem mesmo chegaria a ser Cartucho, e na Italia seria engraxa-botas de Casanova, a sua côr livida representa a alliança com o patibulo, se é que Camillo Castello Branco valesse a ponta do barão necessario para o enforcar. Elle não vale nem mesmo esse pedaço de corda. Deixamos estes traços da sua physionomia; passemos a indicar os mais caracteristicos episodios da sua negra epopêa de iniquidades:

Quando Camillo Castello Branco guardava cabras em Villa Real, causou a ruína de uma pobre rapariga filha de um taverneiro; o pae da criança chamou-o para elle casar com a filha.

Camillo acceitou a proposta com a condição de lhe dar o taverneiro um fato novo e uma moeda. Recebido o ajuste, Camillo fugiu com o fato e o dinheiro para a cidade do Porto, e aqui continuou o seu cyclo de immundas aventuras. Começou desempenhando o papel de aprendiz de padre, recebendo apoio dos jornaes miguelistas e tendo só em vista uma cousa—o rapinar alguns cobres ao bispo. Padres e miguelistas achavam em Camillo um inspirado, capaz de ser um Ravailhac ou um Jacques Clemente; mas o ex-guardador de cabras sacrificou todos os planos dos seus protectores a uma só cousa que tem sido o movel de todas as suas acções—comer e babujar. Com a raiva do asno que morde a albarda, Camillo annullou a protecção d'estas duas influencias descompondo uns e outros. Foi então quando se sentiu uma potencia, que tinha a força do mal para se fazer temer.

Explorou este novo esgoto que se lhe abriu na alma, e assentou banca de descompostura por dinheiro: nas descomposturas que lhe pagaram contra a consorte do conde de Bolhão, a par das libras tambem recebeu algumas moedas de escarros na cara; nas descomposturas contra a snr.^a Brown, recebeu tambem n'isso que de cara passou a ser lata, as publicas chicotadas vibradas por seu filho Ricardo Brown.

Os differentes romances obscenos que foi escrevendo eram uma supporação d'esta necessidade de abocanhar; leram-se os romances para se descobrirem os escandalos portuenses. Mas quando o publico se viu cançado d'este desaforado histrião e os editores se não quizeram mais deixar roubar por elle, Camillo Castello Branco lançou-se n'uma empreza nova: explorou uma mulher casada que tivera a desgraça de ter perdido o senso moral com a leitura frequente d'esses romances a que alludimos. Todos sabem o caso da morte do infeliz marido, e como Camillo Castello Branco foi completar nas enxovias a educação que encetou com as cabras em Villa Real.

Da cadeia começou Camillo a abrir brecha para a rapina na casa Moré, mandando ali mostrar um Romance de descompostura ao dignissimo procurador regio que não lhe tolerou certas obscenidades no carcere; o

amigo do procurador regio, gerente da dita casa, teve de pagar o romance para poupar um desgosto ao magistrado respeitavel. Ainda não ha muito tempo, que o snr. José Gomes Monteiro se refugiu no nosso Escriptorio para evitar o encontro de Camillo na loja Moré, que ia ali armar uma *escroquerie*, com o fim, dizia elle, de pagar uma decima. Livre da cadeia, porque a lei quasi que não admite prova no adulterio, Camillo Castello Branco devorou então os bens d'essa infeliz creatura do Senhor que arrastou á aversão publica. Depois de ter comido o que pertencia á sua victima, viu o que ainda pertencia ao filho d'ella, cujos rendimentos eram utitizados pela mãe, que, por não ter passado a segundas nupcias, ficára com a administração d'esse resto: nada mais natural que armar um cerco a este dinheiro.

Em primeiro lugar não casou com a mulher a quem devia uma reparação, para ella não perder a administração do filho; e em segundo lugar mandou agora a criança para a Africa, na esperança d'elle alli morrer e então poder livremente dispôr d'esse resto de dinheiro. Alerta snr. Curador geral dos orfãos. Por onde quer que se olhe este monturo de crimes, que por ahi infecciona os áres por todos os lados Camillo Castello Branco só mostra aspectos repugnantes; ultimamente comprometteu a sorte de Vieira de Castro com a sua defeza; explorou a desgraça do amigo com o drama o *Condemnado* que vendeu a dous individuos; e por ultimo lucra ainda com a morte do homem de quem se diz amigo, vendendo para o Brazil por 800\$000 reis as cartas que esse desgraçado lhe escreveu da Africa.

Para Camillo Castello Branco as palavras honra, dever, amizade, são como as particulas sacrosantas que tivessem cahido em poder de um macaco; privado do minimo vislumbre de senso moral, a moralidade, a vergonha, o pudor são para elle como as côres para um cego de nascença. Ultimamente aspirou a um titulo de visconde, porque viu alguns negreiros e agiotas ornados com esse distinctivo; elle por tanto achava-se com maior direito para se distinguir pelo seu cynismo. Como alguém do paço se oppôz a que acabassem de degradar os titulos nobiliarchicos, Camillo começou a insultar a Casa de Bragança. Mas como hoje as suas diatribes sujas produzem o effeito contrario ao que elle mira, e como já ninguem lhe pagava para pôr a sua penna ao serviço da calumnia, ligou-se então com um francez devasso chamado Ernesto Chardon, para a publicação de um cano

de despejo intitulado *Insomnias de Camillo Castello Branco*. Este snr. Chardron é aquelle que violou a casa de um seu compatriota, raptando-lhe a mulher, e aquelle mesmo que estaria a estas horas na cadeia, se o gerente da antiga casa Moré tivesse sellado as portas do estabelecimento quando este aventureiro sahiu d'alli para traficar á vontade. Os dois grilhetas acharam-se dignos um do outro; Chardron é o passador dos latrocinios que o Camillo pratica sobre a honra dos que o desauthoraram perante a honestidade. Ora n'este opusculo n.º 7 das *Insomnias de Camillo Castello Branco*, com a sua auctoridade de juiz de enxovia, onde já residiu, diz que eu lhe roubei o livro *Mosaico*, publicando-o contra a sua vontade. Este homem, que tem recebido dinheiro por livros que nunca escreveu, recebeu de nós 14 libras para escrever o *Mosaico*, e mais 9 libras por outra comedella; quando nos viu com o livro em metade da impressão, julgou ter-nos o pé no pescoço e exigiu mais dinheiro. Recusei-me a este logro e exploração sordida, e para não perder o que já lhe tinha dado publiquei o livro na altura em que já estava. Camillo fez-me um arresto, mas o Tribunal da Relação em vista dos documentos de letra do proprio Camillo, mandou-me entregar o que era minha propriedade, por Accordão de 31 de Agosto de 1868. O desgraçado paria, porque um Accordão restabeleceu o meu direito, vem hoje chamar-me ladrão. Não vamos aos tribunaes, porque Camillo Castello Branco manifesta já os primeiros symptomas de demencia, e porque um elogio da sua bôcca seria a maior affronta que podiamos receber. Camillo lembrando-se ainda do tempo em que furtava os brincos ás criadas da casa onde morava, está agora com a monomania de que todos o roubam; eil-o ora nos jornaes a accusar um garoto que o servia, eil-o a restabelecer-lhe os creditos, dando a entender que fôra roubado pela amazia e até pelo proprio filho! Eil-o contando as colheres de prata que pertenceram ao marido da sua victima. Decididamente os amigos de Camillo têm razão para caracterisar-lhe o estado de demencia. Este larapio das livrarias dos fidalgos de provincia, empulhando-os com livros de hippiatrica, e rindo da sua lorpice, este vendilhão acobertado com o pseudonymo de Jorge Correia, tem a audacia da rameira, para chamar aos outros aquillo que o distingue. Assim como Alexandre Herculano o pôz fóra de sua casa, a sociedade devia expungil-o, ficando á conta do municipio o recompensar aquelle que lhe deitasse a bóla.

A nossa vingança está breve: ir-lhe-hemos regar a cova com o que elle sabe, e temos a certeza que assim como se guardam os exemplares dos notaveis aleijões, a memoria ominosa de Camillo Castello Branco hade conservar-se por muito tempo na execração publica como uma das grandes aberrações moraes da especie humana.

N. B. Em vista dos factos que deixamos apontados Camillo Castello Branco perdeu toda a imputação e auctoridade moral.

Por isso, emquanto á accusação que nos fins de não termos pago a dois escriptores os artigos que enviaram para a *Gazeta Litteraria*, temos apenas a dizer ao publico: entregamos a Camillo, como era do contracto, o dinheiro destinado, a esse fim, de que temos os devidos documentos.

Porto, 22 de Julho de 1874.

Anselmo de Moraes.

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK SUPPLEMENTO
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